

Small Fruits & Berries

These are generally the fastest to produce and great for beginners or small spaces.

Fruit Planting Tip Environment Difficulty Time to Fruit

Strawberries Plant with the "crown" (where leaves meet roots) exactly at soil level. Full sun; well-drained soil. Great for pots or hanging baskets. Low

2-3 months (Day-neutral) to 1 year (June-bearing).

Blueberries You must have acidic soil (pH 4.5-5.5). Use peat moss or sulfur to lower pH. Full sun; consistent moisture. Needs a second variety for pollination.

Medium 2-3 years for a decent harvest.

Raspberries Plant in rows and provide a simple trellis or wire to keep canes upright. Full sun; cooler climates preferred. Avoid soggy "wet feet" soil.

Low 1 year (often first fall for "everbearing" types).

Blackberries Choose "thornless" varieties to save your hands. They spread quickly! Full sun; tolerant of many soil types. Need room to roam. Low

Stone & Pome Fruits (Trees)

Tree fruits require more patience and often pruning, but they provide decades of harvests.

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Apples Buy Dwarf or Columnar varieties for easier picking and faster results.

Full sun; requires "chill hours" (winter cold) to set fruit. Medium

2-3 years (Dwarf) to 5-8 years (Standard).

Peaches Prune into an "open bowl" shape to let light reach the center of the tree. Full sun; loves heat but needs well-drained soil. Medium 2-4 years.

Cherries Sour cherries are easier/hardier; Sweet cherries often need a pollinator partner. Full sun; good air circulation is key to preventing rot.

Medium

Unique & Mediterranean Fruits

These often have fewer pest issues and can be very ornamental in a landscape.

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Figs Can be grown in large pots. In cold zones, bring the pot into a garage for winter. Full sun; very drought-tolerant once established. Low 1-2 years.

Grapes Requires a very sturdy trellis or fence. Prune back 90% of new growth each winter. Full sun; deep, well-drained soil. Needs heat to sweeten. Medium
3 years.

Meyer Lemons If you aren't in a tropical zone, grow these in pots to move indoors for winter. Full sun (8+ hours); high humidity; heavy feeders (need fertilizer). Medium

Pro-Tips for Success

- Pollination: Many fruit trees are not "self-fertile." This means you might need two different varieties (e.g., a Gala apple and a Fuji apple) blooming at the same time to get fruit.

- The "Wait" Rule: For young trees, it is often best to pinch off any fruit that forms in the first year. This forces the plant to put energy into its root system rather than one or two tiny apples.

- Drainage: Most fruit plants hate "wet feet." If your soil is heavy clay, plant in raised beds to ensure the roots don't rot.